

- Turn off the water while you brush your teeth.
- Turn off the water in between hand washing dishes, or use tubs to rinse instead.
- Depending on how brave you are, you could also possibly skip a few toilet flushes!

While it might be hard to remember these seven things every day, choose just one or two to focus on until you're doing them automatically. Then move on to create one or two more habits until they become second nature.

4. KEEP AN EYE OUT FOR LEAKS

A couple years ago, we had a slightly leaky toilet that resulted in a \$320 water bill...for the *month*. How did we not know our toilet was leaking? Because the tank didn't have a good seal, and as a result, went unnoticed for quite a while. Oh my, did it result in a crazy expensive bill!

As you can probably imagine, we watch our toilets, sinks, and under-counter plumbing pipes like a hawk now. It's a good reminder to check for leaks every now and then, even ones you assume might not be much of a problem. A slow, steady drip produces approximately 100 drips per minute, resulting in 330 gallons per month.

Some leaks are fixable with a few basic tools and a couple YouTube tutorials, but others might require the assistance of a plumber. Depending on the significance of the leak, it could be costly, but rest assured, this will pay for itself over the course of the year.

DID YOU KNOW?

Washing dishes by hand actually uses more water than the dishwasher. Stop over-rinsing dishes and let your dishwasher do the work instead.

5. UPDATE YOUR APPLIANCES